



Twitter subscription service

Twitter Blue subscription service will enable themes, add an undo button, make threads read friendly, etc. <http://digit.in/jun21-17>



Spotify to auto-transcribe podcasts

The company says the goal is to eventually "enable transcripts across all podcasts on Spotify." <http://digit.in/jun21-18>

ZOTAC GAMING GeForce RTX 3080 Ti AMP Holo Graphics Card

Practically an RTX 3090

NVIDIA announced the GeForce RTX 3080 Ti and the RTX 3070 Ti at COMPUTEX 2021. Up until now, NVIDIA only had AMD to contend with but that's set to change as Intel's discrete gaming GPU is also right around the corner. As is tradition, the "Ti" cards are slightly better than their non-Ti variants. With 80 Streaming Multiprocessors, the RTX 3080 Ti is just two units shy of the RTX 3090. This makes the RTX 3080 Ti much closer to the RTX 3090 than the RTX 3080.

BUILD QUALITY

ZOTAC went for a design refresh with the launch of the NVIDIA RTX 30-series. It's mostly visual changes. The hardware has to follow the specifications laid down by NVIDIA. The RTX 30-series cards consume a lot of power and we had a lot of capacitor-related issues early on which were resolved in the first few weeks post-launch. The ZOTAC GAMING GeForce RTX 3080 Ti AMP Holo is a triple-slot card and has a pretty thick heatsink. There's a metal bracket running along the length of the board to provide rigidity and we can count 10 heat pipes in all.

The AMP Holo uses a triple-fan cooler on the front and we can see that ZOTAC has paid more attention to the shroud. The air is now better channels through the fins with reduced blow-back. The overall colour scheme has a little black among a sea of grey that ZOTAC has been known for.

The back is guarded with a backplate with a few RGB diffusers embedded in them. It's a mix of plastic and metal. Cutouts have been provided near the power sockets to allow easy insertion and removal of the PCIe power connectors.

For the ports, the ZOTAC GAMING GeForce RTX 3080 Ti AMP Holo comes with three DisplayPorts (1.4a) and one HDMI 2.1 port. You will need a Ultra High Speed HDMI cable to connect an 8K/60 FPS or 4K/120 FPS panel. Lastly, the inner side is sealed off with little air spewing from that end.

PERFORMANCE

Starting off with synthetic benchmarks, the ZOTAC GeForce RTX 3080 Ti AMP Holo scores a little over 12000 points in 3DMark Fire Strike Ultra and nearly 18000 points in Time Spy. This places it right next to the RTX 3090. In Basemark, the RTX 3080 Ti scores ahead of the 6900 XT in DirectX12, Vulkan and OpenGL benchmarks but falls short of the RTX 3090.

In our gaming benchmarks, we saw 174 FPS in Battlefield V, 205 FPS in Death Stranding, 126 FPS in Metro Exodus, 121 FPS in Red Dead Redemption II, 180 FPS in Shadow of the Tomb Raider and 270 FPS in The Witcher III. These scores put it well within the vicinity of the RTX 3090. In fact, we even saw the RTX 3080 Ti score a little higher than the RTX 3090 because the optimisations and improvements introduced in the drivers since the RTX 3090 was launched and tested by us have



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PERFORMANCE.....	87
VALUE.....	75
DESIGN.....	80

obviously had an impact. If we retest the RTX 3090, we will see better performance on it over the 3080 Ti.

POWER CONSUMPTION AND THERMALS

During most of our gaming benchmarks, we saw the ZOTAC RTX 3080 Ti AMP Holo hit a peak of 78 degrees celsius. During overclocking with the power limits removed, this would go up to 86 degrees. Peak power consumption levels during the gaming benchmarks was 320 watts during a run that took up close to 94% GPU usage.

VERDICT

The ZOTAC RTX 3080 Ti AMP Holo is practically the RTX 3090. It's performance is very similar given that barely any games take advantage of the higher VRAM on the RTX 3090. Sure, synthetic benchmarks would indicate these two cards to be miles apart but for the gamer who wants all the bells and whistles, the RTX 3080 Ti is one of the prime candidates.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CUDA CORES: 10240 | SM: 80 | BOOST CLOCK: 1710 MHz | VRAM: 12 GB GDDR6X | BUS-WIDTH: 384-bit | CONNECTORS: 2x 8-PIN | TBP: 350W

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Price
₹1,47,000

